A BOOK ABOUT

MENTAL POWER AND **PERSONAL SUCCESS**

MICHAEL PILARCZYK

MASTER YOUR MINDSET

LIVE A MEANINGFUL LIFE

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MICHAEL PILARCZYK

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The book you now have in your hands is like a shovel that you can use to dig within yourself. You'll discover answers and insights that will give you guidance on where you want to go in your life. You can unearth all the truths about yourself if you're willing to dig deep into the mine of your own soul. If you do, you'll discover that you are the creator of your own character and the designer of your own destiny.

—Michael George Pilarczyk

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Author Note

This book is intended to help you reach your maximum potential and make a positive difference in the world. We cannot give you any guarantees of the results. We do not believe in programs and books that promise wealth, success, happiness, or enlightenment in a short time. These can only be achieved through hard and smart work, a well-founded strategic plan, delivering unique added value, perseverance, and serving others with your talents and quality services. Any action you take related to the contents of this book is your own responsibility. Decisions based on the contents of this book are made voluntarily. We advise you to consult your specialists before you undertake any drastic actions that can have consequences of any nature whatsoever. Under no circumstances will the author and publisher be held liable for any consequences and/or results arising from the use of this book. We wish you success and happiness.

Live your best life!

"I am the master of my faith
The captain of my soul."

—*William Ernest Henley*, Invictus

"A beautiful, healthy, wealthy, and successful life is possible for so many people, if only there was access to the right insights, key knowledge, good role models, and extraordinary teachers to learn from."

Introduction

This Book Can Change Your Life

How would you like to live your ideal life? A meaningful life, whatever that may look like to you personally. To paint a clearer picture of that, I wrote this book for you.

Can one book change your life? Absolutely. With me that was certainly the case. The book was *Think and Grow Rich* by Napoleon Hill. I was 21 the first time I read it, and it became the foundation for the way I live. Since then, I've been fortunate enough to become a renowned DJ, TV host, successful businessman, world sailor, meditation teacher, inspirational speaker, and bestselling author.

Yes, I've been very fortunate to make all my dreams come true, and I'm very grateful for that. But success never comes without setbacks, disappointments, and deep lows. Sometimes life takes you on a bumpy ride and tries to knock you down. But for those

who pass that mental test and refuse to give up, life offers a fair reward. For me, that reward was financial freedom at the age of 37.

A beautiful, healthy, wealthy, and successful life is possible for so many people, if only there was access to the right insights, key knowledge, good role models, and extraordinary teachers to learn from. I know from experience that I can be that person, helping you live your best life. How do I know that? Well, I am living my best life. I'm 55 now. I've been through a lot and I have learned a lot. But most importantly, I practice what I preach.

Here's an important piece of advice to remember: if someone wants to show you the way, first ask if they've walked that path themselves. Never just take someone's word for it. Always ask yourself if that person has the right to speak on the matter. What have they accomplished themselves?

Now, you may be thinking, "Yeah, that's easy for you to say, but such a rich and luxurious life isn't in the cards for everyone." And maybe it's not for everyone—but not everyone will read this book. You, however, are reading it. So, what's on your wish list? Happiness, money, personal growth? Your dream home with the love of your life? More free time, a trip around the world, your own business, living on the beach or in the quiet mountains? More peace of mind? What does your best life look like? Have you ever seriously thought about that? And more importantly, have you written down that wish list in concrete terms?

In this book, I'll ask a lot of questions—because questions are more important than answers. Questions make you think, and thinking leads to insights. Why do you do what you do? Why do you think the way you do? And how do you know if your thoughts align with the life you truly want to live? If you pay close attention while reading this book, the answers will arise within you.

This isn't a theoretical self-help book. I don't believe in programs or books that promise quick success, instant wealth, or enlightenment. Nor do I believe you have to be a millionaire to live your best life—though having money is practical. Money can

help you achieve your goals and create the lifestyle you desire, but it's not the whole picture.

Much of this book is about awareness. Getting to the bottom of yourself so that you understand what causes your thinking and your behavior. This will give you peace of mind and also the power to start living life the way you want. You will be less likely to lose yourself in emotions that determine your behavior, and you will spend much less time brooding. On the contrary, you will become much more decisive in the choices you make, and you will gain more control over your behavior and thus over your daily life. And only when you know yourself are you able to understand how other people think and able to explain their behavior. This makes your dealings with others easier, and you will find that, as a result, many obstacles you're faced with and resistance you face will disappear from your life. It paves the way to start living your life the way you would prefer. A meaningful life.

Master Your Mindset is based on the *Think and Grow Rich* principles, to which I have added my own unique experiences in life and business, and all the valuable lessons I've learned from my teachers, including my business mentor, Mr. Dan Peña.

I share with you my personal story. How I, by trial and error, made my dreams come true, found inner peace, and achieved freedom, both spiritually and financially. Is this what you want too? Then you'll find questions and answers in this book that will help you on your way. I share what I've done and how I've done it. And how you can apply the same way of thinking and the same strategy to improve the quality of your own life.

Don't expect your life to suddenly look completely different tomorrow. That requires more than simply reading this book. You have to study it and live it. I will help you along the way, and I will explain to you in detail what you have to do. I'll guide you through it, you'll reflect on it, and ultimately, you'll decide what to do with it. But it's also important to know that without action there will be no results.

You can't change your life in a day, but you can change your daily life. The secret of long-lasting success is found in your daily routine. Gold and diamonds are only found by searching and digging. The book you now have in your hands is like a shovel that you can use to dig within yourself. You'll discover answers and insights that will give you guidance on where you want to go in your life. You can unearth all the truths about yourself if you're willing to dig deep into the mine of your own soul. If you do, you'll discover that you are the creator of your own character and the maker of your own destiny.

> *"Life is an adventure waiting to be taken on,*
> *a mystery to discover, an opportunity to seize,*
> *a challenge to take up.*
> *Life is both the journey and the destination.*
> *Life is so beautiful.*
> *Wake up, live."*

What Does Your Best Life Look Like?

This might not be an easy question. It's a big question. And to understand big things, it's best to break it down into manageable chunks. You don't need to be able to answer that question in detail yet.

To begin with: What would you like to change in your daily life? Why aren't you doing more of what you would like to be doing? And why do you do things even though you'd rather not? After we explore these questions, I'll take you through more philosophical questions. Why do you get out of bed every day? Why do you do what you do? What do you do it all for? Finally, the last questions, and not the easiest ones: Who are you really, deep down? And who do you want to be?

This book is about these essential life questions.

I've asked thousands of people these questions. Virtually no one has been able to give clear and concrete answers to them. Yet

their importance has become increasingly clear to me. They make you think; they bring insights. They awaken your consciousness. Both the questions and the many different answers to them remind me of Apple founder Steve Jobs' legendary words at Stanford University in 2005: "Your time is limited, so don't waste it by living someone else's life. Don't be trapped by dogma—which is living with the results of other people's thinking. Don't let the noise of other people's opinions drown out your own inner voice. And most importantly, have the courage to follow your heart and intuition. They somehow know what you genuinely want."

To live your best life, you first have to master your mindset, master the way you think. That way of thinking determines your vision of the world around you and of yourself, your self-image. Using countless examples and my own experiences, I'll help you understand your way of thinking: how it came to be and the unseen blockages that might now be preventing you from living your best life.

Do you feel like you're not yet making use of your full personal potential, that there's more to you? Do you have goals you want to achieve? Do you have dreams you want to make come true? Do you want to give deeper meaning to who you are and what you do?

The examples I use in this book will show how your thoughts guide your behavior. And that your behavior determines both your daily actions and the results you get. It all starts with the way you think.

It's important to be aware of your thoughts and of the fact that you are the cause of that mental activity. Realize that you assign meaning to every thought with that intelligent brain of yours. And that through infusing thoughts with meaning, you give rise to certain feelings and emotions. Additionally, every judgment you have is also the result of the meaning you assign to your thoughts. Reading this book now, you're forming thoughts about it—you have an opinion on it. You might agree or disagree with what I have to say. Where does that opinion come from?

Over the years and while I was doing research for this book, it became clear to me how the way we think comes about. It's the result of our perception, and our perception isn't an objective representation of reality. It's the lens through which you see life. It's your personal reality. Not pure, therefore, but colored. "Reality is merely an illusion, albeit a very persistent one," claimed Albert Einstein.

Watching a film is a good example of how your perception determines your reality. Despite the fact that you know what is on screen isn't real, you can have a sleepless night after watching an exciting thriller or a gripping drama. And how many times have you not shed a tear or two when watching an especially heartbreaking death scene? Your thoughts and emotions can, therefore, make you believe in something that resembles reality yet is actually made up.

Something similar happens when you watch an illusionist. You know beforehand that what you're going to see isn't real, but still, you believe in that temporary illusion. Things don't only work that way when you're watching a movie or an illusionist. It's also how you look at the outside world. You experience it as reality through your perception, and through the personal lenses of your conditioning.

Your experience of reality is affected by everything that filters through the lens of your perception. Day in, day out, you're programmed by what you see and read: the news. But is all that news true? Is everything you see really real? In recent years, we've heard the term "fake news" bandied about, but what is that, really? And who decides what's true and what isn't? Some people are convinced that something is true "because it was on the news." Still others don't believe everything just because someone said so and do their own research into "the truth." In this way, everyone chooses their own truth to believe in.

One final example: Just like you use a filter to edit photos on Instagram to make them more beautiful, you view the outside

world through your own filter. And that filter colors things the way you want to see them. This is called a paradigm: a frame of reference from which you interpret reality. Your convictions are formed from that frame of reference. In this book, we're going to carefully investigate that filter. I want to show you the influence that filter has on your view of the world and on yourself. And vice versa: What influence do you have on your own filter?

Your filter is the consequence of your paradigms and conditioning; it's your way of thinking. And since you are the cause of your thoughts, you also have the ability and the opportunity to change those thoughts, and thereby change what you see and what you get in life.

The title of this book is *Master Your Mindset: Live a Meaningful Life*. Your mindset is your way of thinking, and it determines how you lead your life: whether you're happy and successful or not, how you interact with others and with yourself, how you deal with your feelings, and whether you live life the way you'd like. Your behavior is, therefore, a direct consequence of your mindset. Do you want to improve something about yourself, your behavior, and the quality of your daily life? Then you'll need to change your mindset and your convictions.

If you're 25 years old, you'll read this book differently than if you're 40 or 55. Where you're at on your life path largely determines how you'll interpret my words. The beauty of it is that everything I write is universal. It works for everyone, including you, provided you're open to it.

That's why I ask you to read this book with an open mind. Read receptively suspend your judgment. I have no intention to convince you of anything, so I'm not out to prove anything. I'm not a scientist. But I know what works based on my own experience and the results of the tens of thousands of people I've taught in recent years.

If you don't believe in what I have to tell you, it won't work for you. First believe, and then you'll see. That's my mantra.